Education in Science and Technology

The Government of India in the meantime adopted measures to strengthen the much neglected sphere of science and technology in the country. Before the end of three plan periods five IITs, 17 national laboratories specialising in different areas of research, Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR), Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Atomic Energy Commission had been established. Thereafter D.P. Chattopadhyay Committee on Teacher Education1983, National Education Policy Commission, 1986, Acharya Ramamurthy Review Committee of 1990, Yashpal Committee 1993, T.S.R. Subramanian Committee (2015) constituted with the objective of reforming the curriculum in keeping with the changing time, had come up with several recommendations.



IIT Madras

Accomplishment until Now

Thanks to the remedial measures taken by the successive governments, both Union and State, based on the reports of the said Commissions and Committees, as well as the governmental programmes such as scholarships to the meritorious, deprived and disadvantaged, waiving of tuition fee for undergraduate courses, free uniform and noon meal schemes in schools, the enrolment rate increased and dropout rate decreased remarkably in schools. As a sequence male literacy 2019-21 stood at 84.4% (against 27.2% in 1951) and female literacy stood at 71.5% (against 8.9 in 1951). In 2018 about 36.6 million students were in 907 institutes of higher learning (against 58 institutes in 1956).

Recap

- In ancient period the pupils were taught in ashramas and hermitages to memorize vedic hymns
- Education under gurukula system was organized in quarters and private houses of learned teachers.
- Temples and mutts functioned as a place for imparting formal education during the medieval period.
- Maktabs (Muslim schools) and Madrasas (institution of higher education) started with admission to all without restrictions.
- Support of Governor Generals, Warren Hastings and Cornwallis for oriental learning.
- The contribution of Christian missionaries to modern education in general and women's education in particular.
- The national government's measures for modernisation of education by appointing commissions:
  - Dr. Radhakrishnan Commission (1948)
  - Dr. Lakshmanaswami Mudaliyar Commission (1952)
  - Kothari Commission (1964)
  - Progress in education – A comparison of condition in the immediate post – independence period and condition at the close of second decade of the 21st century.

5_History_Unit-5_EM.indd 54 03/04/2023 13:50:55